

Codebook for analysis in table 3

The following variables are included in the datafile that is generated from the files “SEAD governor quarterly v1.dta” or the file “controls for table 3.dta” and are used to generate the analysis in Table 3 or in Tables A1-A2.

state: The name of the state

statenumber: The number of the state (in alphabetic order)-this variable identifies the panel for pooled time-series analysis.

year: The year in which the survey was conducted

quarter: The quarter for which the latent approval rating is estimated (1, 2, 3, or 4)

qtr: The quarter-year of the approval estimate in stata date conventions; this is the variable that identifies the time period for time-series analysis.

quarter_year: A second measure of the quarter year, calculated by adding the quarter divided by 10 to the year such that it takes the value of year.quarter

Approval_Smoothed: Executive Approval Smoothed. The latent measure of governor approval (calculated from "positive" in the SEAD dataset) that included the use of smoothing in the wcalc calculations.

Approval_Not_Smoothed: Executive Approval Not Smoothed. The latent measure of governor approval (calculated from "positive" in the SEAD dataset) that did not include the use of smoothing in the wcalc calculations.

Disapproval_Smoothed: Executive Disapproval Smoothed. The latent measure of governor disapproval (calculated from "negative" in the SEAD dataset) that included the use of smoothing in the wcalc calculations.

Disapproval_Not_Smoothed: Executive Disapproval Not Smoothed. The latent measure of governor disapproval (calculated from "negative" in the SEAD dataset) that did not include the use of smoothing in the wcalc calculations.

Relative_Smoothed: Relative Executive Approval Smoothed. The latent measure of relative governor approval (calculated from "App_AppDis" in the SEAD dataset) that included the use of smoothing in the wcalc calculations. Note that this is not calculated from the approval or disapproval calculations and so it is possible that a state can have this series converge but not one of the other ones (and vice versa).

Relative_Not_Smoothed: Relative Executive Approval Not Smoothed. The latent measure of relative governor approval (calculated from "App_AppDis" in the SEAD dataset) that did not include the use of smoothing in the wcalc calculations. Note that this is not calculated from the approval or disapproval calculations and so it is possible that a state can have have this series converge but not one of the other ones (and vice versa).

valid_surveys: Number of valid surveys in the quarter that were used to estimate the atent measure for that quarter. If this variable takes the value of 0, wcalc imputes the value from the previous quarter.

valid_3qtr: A dummy variable that takes the value of 0 if this quarter and two consecutive quarters are imputed and 1 otherwise. This is the minimum level of data continuity that I use in the analysis.

gov_party: The governor's party. 1=Democrat, 2=Republican, 3=Other or independent. The analysis breaks this variable into dummy variables. Coded as of the start of the governor's term by the author from Wikipedia biographies.

electionquarter: A dummy variable for the election quarter. 1 if an election for governor was held in the state that quarter and 0 otherwise. Coded by the author.

not_elected: A dummy variables designating governors who were not elected as governor and became governor after the previous governor resigned, was impeached, or died. 0=elected, 1=not elected. Coded by the author from Wikipedia biographies.

female: A dummy variable for a female governor. 1=female, 0=male. Coded by the author.

governorresignedthatquarter: A dummy variable for the governor having resigned that quarter. 1=if they resigned and 0 otherwise. Coded by the author from Wikipedia biographies.

governordiedthatquarter: A dummy variable measuring if the governor died that quarter in office. 1 if they died in office and 0 otherwise. Coded by the author from Wikipedia biographies.

unemployment_state: Average Unemployment Rate in the Quarter, non-seasonally adjusted. Takes data from the bureau of labor statistics table on Employment status of the civilian noninstitutional population, non-seasonably adjusted. The spreadsheet has the unemployment rate by month; I take the average for each quarter across the three months. Data are available at <https://www.bls.gov/lau/rdscnp16.htm>, under the link "Employment status of the civilian noninstitutional population, not seasonally adjusted" as a zip file. The data used here were downloaded in May 2021.

quarter1_first_valid: A dummy variable for being in the first quarter of a governor's first term; 1 if you are in the quarter, 0 otherwise. It is coded as missing if no valid surveys were conducted that quarter to not underestimate the size of the honeymoon with imputed data. Coded by the author.

quarter2_first_valid: A dummy variable for being in the second quarter of a governor's first term; 1 if you are in the quarter, 0 otherwise. It is coded as missing if no valid surveys were conducted that quarter to not underestimate the size of the honeymoon with imputed data. Coded by the author.

quarter3_first_valid: A dummy variable for being in the third quarter of a governor's first term; 1 if you are in the quarter, 0 otherwise. It is coded as missing if no valid surveys were conducted that quarter to not underestimate the size of the honeymoon with imputed data. Coded by the author.

quarter1_repeat_valid: A dummy variable for being in the first quarter of a governor's second term or later term; 1 if you are in the quarter, 0 otherwise. It is coded as missing if no valid surveys were conducted that quarter to not underestimate the size of the honeymoon with imputed data. Coded by the author.

quarter2_repeat_valid: A dummy variable for being in the second quarter of a governor's second term or later term; 1 if you are in the quarter, 0 otherwise. It is coded as missing if no valid surveys were conducted that quarter to not underestimate the size of the honeymoon with imputed data. Coded by the author.

quarter3_repeat_valid: A dummy variable for being in the third quarter of a governor's second term or later term; 1 if you are in the quarter, 0 otherwise. It is coded as missing if no valid surveys were conducted that quarter to not underestimate the size of the honeymoon with imputed data. Coded by the author.